

Dillon Colbert

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Education

Washington University St. Louis, MO
BS Environmental Engineering, Minor in Energy Engineering – McKelvey School of Engineering May 2025

New York University New York, NY
MS Urban Data Science – Tandon School of Engineering, Center for Urban Science + Progress May 2028

Experience

Freelance Writer New York, NY (remote)
Streetsblog USA Feb 2026 – Present

- Journalism to reduce car dependency, where I published “Chicago to St. Louis Is the High-Speed Rail Test America Can’t Afford to Fail” on March 31, 2026

Community Design Researcher Gateway South Redevelopment, St. Louis, MO
Washington University, Sam Fox School of Design & Visual Arts Mar 2025 – Mar 2026

- Work with community partner Counterpublic to examine physical barriers in the built environment (highways, industry, vacancy, etc.) and understand connectivity limitations around the site

Fall Intern St. Louis, MO
Citizens for Modern Transit Sep – Dec 2025

- Quantified vacant sites on future transit corridors to convey transit-oriented development potential to local government

Sustainability Consultant Ferguson, MO
City of Ferguson Jan – May 2025

- Interviewed political leaders, regional nonprofit partners, and citizens to draft a need-based community engagement plan

Building Decarbonization Intern St. Louis, MO
Midwest Climate Collaborative (MCC), Washington University Office of Sustainability May – Dec 2024

- Performed energy audits on 6 community organization-owned properties and managed data for 200 properties to initialize a program for decarbonizing low-income, multifamily housing
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Leadership & Activities

Laclede’s Landing Main Street Organization St. Louis, MO
Design Committee Member Oct 2025 – Present

- Coordinate stakeholders to align new development with the 2015 North Riverfront Open Space & Redevelopment Plan

STL Urbanists, Strong Towns St. Louis St. Louis, MO
Conversation Leader Jun 2025 – Present

- Organize campaigns to discuss local built-environment problems – primarily parking reform, highway removal, & housing
- Created the bikeshare working group in Oct 2025 to restart conversation about the 2014 St. Louis Bike Share Study
- Analyze data with ArcGIS to map transit metrics (ridership per mile, on-time performance) and calculate local parking ratios

WUrbanists – Washington University Transportation and Mobility Club St. Louis, MO
President Jul 2024 – May 2025

- Led initiatives showcasing the urban fabric of St. Louis via active transportation to encourage student engagement in the City
- Added 40 members, raised event attendance from 0-3 to 15-20, upgraded the funding category, and strengthened partnerships with other clubs and local nonprofits, significantly expanding the footprint and operating capacity of the organization

American Council for an Energy-Efficient Economy (ACEEE) Pacific Grove, CA
Conference Attendee: Summer Study on Energy Efficiency in Buildings Jul 2024

- Represented the MCC and Washington University at ACEEE’s biennial response to the climate crisis, where I attended panels, workshops, and lectures to learn national best practices for building decarbonization and energy policy
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Awards & Interests

Awards: CityStudioSTL Fellowship, Honors in Innovation & Entrepreneurship, SP2025 Dean’s List

Interests/Hobbies: Music, urban history, neighborhood walks, libraries, parks, sports: soccer, baseball, basketball, running

Technical Skills: GIS (advanced), Microsoft Office (advanced), Adobe Suite, CAD, MATLAB, R, Python, SketchUp